

external  
demand cycle

*orders rose and fell,  
the factory followed*

disruption or  
measurement error

*a stable operation  
made to look unstable*

internal policy  
amplification

*production and staffing  
rules amplified a  
small disturbance*

weakened if the order  
history lacks the swing

weakened if dated records  
show no error that large

weakened if a reconstruction  
cannot produce the swing

one observed swing

*heavy operation, then half laid off*